

MUS 150/THEA 150, Spring 2026: FINAL EXAM
POSSIBILITIES

[I've included the directions you will see on the Final as well.]

I. Listening: 48 points, 6 at 8 points each, 40 minutes

Six excerpts will be played, twice each, with a brief pause between excerpts. **(For #6, a video excerpt will be played three times.)**

- Identify, as appropriate: composer, lyricist, show title, approximate date, dramatic context/character(s) in this excerpt.
- Describe any striking musical features that you **hear in the excerpt** (form, type of music, style, word painting, quotation, poetic details, etc.) and the significance of the excerpt. For #6, focus instead on description of the relationship between visual and musical elements.

Full sentences are *not* necessary.

Selected from:

Guys and Dolls: "Fugue for Tinhorns" or "Oldest Established..."

Frozen: "Fixer Upper"

Beauty and the Beast: "Be Our Guest"

Fiddler on the Roof: "To Life"

West Side Story any of the songs discussed in class are fair game

Gypsy: "Together" or "Rose's Turn" or "Some People"

Cabaret: "Wilkommen" or "If You Could See Her"

Chicago: "All I Care About" or "When You're Good to Mama" or "He Had it Coming"

A Chorus Line: "I Hope I Get It"

Godspell: "All for the Best"

Jesus Christ, Superstar: "Superstar"

Hair: "Aquarius"

Rent: "Tango Maureen" or "La vie Boheme"

Phantom of the Opera: "Music of the Night" or "Think of Me"

Cats: "Memory" or "Old Deuteronomy"

Falsettos: "I'm Breaking Down"

Fun Home: "Changing My Major"

Wicked: "Loathing"

Hamilton: "What Did I Miss?" or "It's Quiet Uptown" or "Helpless"

#6 Video possibilities: "Money" from *Cabaret* movie; "Singing in the Rain" sequence *Singing in the Rain*; Barbershop scene: "Oldest established..." from *Guys and Dolls*; "In Summer" from *Frozen*

II. Short Answer Identifications: 50 points, 10 at 5 points each, 50 minutes

Identify/define/describe/explain 10 of the following. Cite examples, names, terms, etc., as appropriate. Explain *significance* where appropriate. Full sentences are *not* necessary; **complete answers are**. Answer **ONLY 10** of the following and label your answers.

Selected from: (I will put around 15-20 of these on the exam for you to pick from. You will notice that a bunch of these are directly related to others on this list so this list of possibilities is not as long as it looks at first. Study all of your notes.)

Gene Kelly

Comden and Green

"Make em Laugh"

the Freed Unit

"Fugue for Tinhorns"

Runyonland

list 5 film musicals with music by Alan Menken

Julie Taymor

New Amsterdam Theater

"Tradition"

Tevye

Jerome Robbins

"Immigrant goes to America, / Lots of hellos in America; / Nobody knows in America / Puerto Rico's in America"

mambo

"Let Me Entertain You"

"Rose's Turn"

Hal (Harold) Prince

Boris Aronson

Joel Grey

"Mr. Cellophane"

Bob Fosse

Michael Bennett

concept musical

"Again! Step, kick, kick, leap, kick, touch."

Godspell

"All for the Best"

Tim Rice

Tim O'Horgan

The Living Theatre

Jonathan Larson

"La Vie Boheme"

"Tango Maureen"

The Public Theater

"Aquarius"

rock musicals

Follies

list 5 shows with music + lyrics by Sondheim (not *Company* or *Sunday in the Park*)

megamusical

Cameron Mackintosh

"touch me, it's so easy to leave me"

"Music of the Night"

name 5 shows directed by Hal Prince

List 5 Andrew Lloyd Webber musicals

"I'm Breaking Down"

Stephen Schwartz

La Cage aux Folles

List indications Elphaba and Glinda are a queer couple

In the Heights

"Such a blunder sometimes it makes me wonder why I even bring the thunder"

tritone

camp/campy (with examples)

III. Survey: 2 points, 1 question

What has been your favorite Musical that we have encountered since the midterm exam?

Support/explain your answer in 2-4 sentences. (Answer in the blue book.)

IV. Essays: 50 points, 2 at 25 points each, 60 minutes total

Write two well-written, organized, and insightful essays on the two questions/topics below. Your essays should exhibit a broad knowledge of Broadway Musical history and should include reference to specific examples. (You should not attempt to discuss or mention every possible example relating to the topic. Avoid focusing on musicals covered in our two paper assignments and avoid using the same specific examples for both essays.)

[SEE SIDE TWO]

WRITE ALL ANSWERS IN BLUE BOOKS

Prof. Sheppard

MUS 150/THEA 150: FINAL EXAM, ESSAY QUESTIONS

Below are the two essay questions that will appear on the final exam (Saturday, May 23, 1:30 to 4:00, in Presser). You will be asked to write **two** well-written and insightful essays that demonstrate your knowledge of Broadway Musical history. Both questions are intentionally broad, allowing you to develop your own ideas. In preparation for this section of the exam, you should review readings and class notes from throughout the semester and draw upon GLOW recordings to refresh your memory. Your essays should exhibit a broad knowledge of Broadway history and should include reference to specific examples. (Avoid using the same specific examples for both essays and avoid discussing musicals covered in the two paper assignments.) You may wish to memorize outlines for your essays prior to the exam, but **NO** notes or materials may be brought into the examination room. Also, your studying and work in preparation for this section of the exam should be **entirely individual**—no team studying for the essay questions. Together, the two essay questions are worth one third of the final exam grade, and thus are worth 10% of the final course grade.

1) Racial and ethnic representation has been central to American musical theater from its inception. These representational goals have shaped the style and content of music and lyrics, details of staging, and casting decisions. Thinking back through history and making reference to multiple examples, to what extent have these representational tropes persisted or evolved over time?

AND

2) As a genre, the Broadway (and Hollywood) Musical has aimed for a total theatrical experience throughout its history, bringing together poetry, music, choreography, acting, staging, etc.. Musicals have consistently featured major show-stopping production numbers designed to achieve an overwhelming impact and to express dramatic, emotional, political, or spiritual meanings. Carefully select 3 such moments from different periods to consider in detail and to compare how the various theatrical/multimedia elements work together to achieve expressive goals in your selected examples.